INTERNATIONAL MARITIME ORGANIZATION

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Circular Letter No.3547/Add.1
20 April 2022

To: All IMO Member States and Associate Members

Subject: **Invitation for the nomination of qualified auditors pursuant to section 4.3 of the Procedures for the IMO Member State Audit**

1 At its 125th regular session (28 June 2021 to 13 July 2021), the Council noted that the percentage of women that had been nominated by Member States and placed on the roster of qualified auditors was meagre and decided to call on Member States to nominate women in particular for inclusion in the roster.

2 In addition to the above decision of the Council, resolution A.1147(31), among others, urges Member States to strive to reach a barrier-free environment for women by considering ways to continuously identify and overcome the existing constraints in all aspects of the maritime sector; in particular, recruitment, training, capacity-building, technical cooperation and promotions, so that all women can participate fully, safely and without hindrance in the activities of the maritime community, including seafaring and shipbuilding activities, and to effectively facilitate the achievement of SDG 5.

3 In this regard, Member States are encouraged to consider the need to eliminate the gender gap among qualified auditors when nominating potential auditors for inclusion in the roster or participating in relevant training programmes.

4 In nominating potential auditors, Member States should ensure that the competencies and attributes of the nominees are in line with the qualifications and criteria, as set out in section 4.3 of the Procedures. In particular, proficiency in at least one of the six official IMO languages, knowledge of international conventions and functions of a maritime administration, and demonstrable auditing skills and experience.

5 To facilitate the process, individuals who are to be nominated by Member States are urged to update their profile on E-roster providing all relevant information. Guidance on the procedure for nomination of auditors is set out in the annex to Circular Letter No.3547.

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